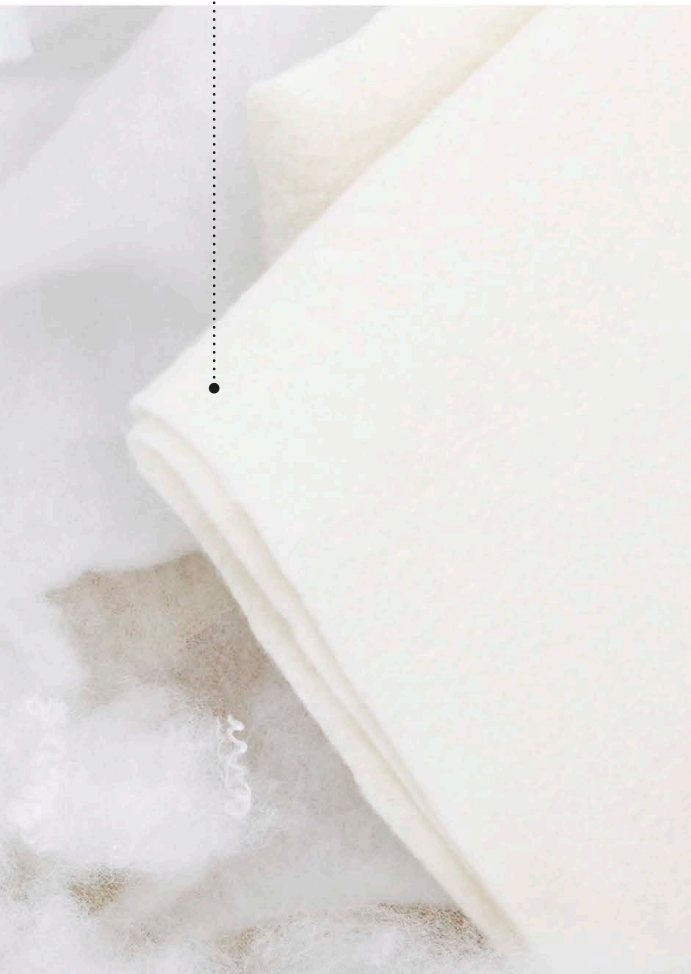


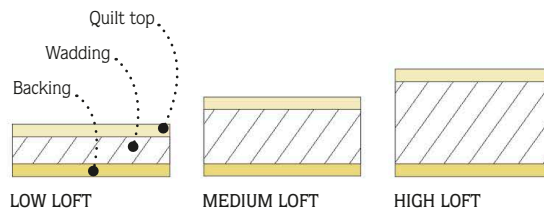
Bamboo

Natural and eco-friendly, bamboo is soft and strong. It generally has a low loft and will not shrink very much. Bamboo blends are also available, often as a 50/50 cotton blend.



LOFT

Loft, or weight, refers to the thickness of a wadding. The higher the loft, the thicker the wadding, and the warmer the quilt. A low-loft wadding is typically less than 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) thick and is easy to quilt. A medium-loft wadding is about 6–12mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ – $\frac{1}{2}$ in) in thickness and can still be machine or hand quilted. A high-loft wadding is generally over 1.2cm ($\frac{1}{2}$ in) and is difficult to quilt. It should therefore be held together with evenly spaced ties (see p.137).



QUILTING YOUR WADDING

The product label on your wadding should state the amount of space you can have un-quilted between quilting stitches for that specific type of wadding. If you are planning to have limited quilting on your quilt, you should take this into consideration when choosing your wadding to make sure it can accommodate the design. The distance can vary significantly, anywhere from approximately 5–25cm (2–10in), depending on what the wadding is made of and how it has been formed.

BUYING WADDING

Wadding is available to buy off the bolt in different widths and often in pre-cut standard bed quilt sizes. When buying wadding, you need to know the finished size of the quilt you are making first. The wadding should be at least 15cm (6in) larger in both width and length than the finished quilt top, to allow it to overhang on all sides when making your quilt sandwich (see p.44).

If you're not able to find a piece of wadding that is wide enough to fit your quilt, you will need to buy enough wadding so that you can piece together several lengths to meet your requirements. You can piece the wadding with either a vertical or horizontal seam depending on which will result in the least waste.